



Assessment Details and Submission Guidelines	
Trimester	T1 2026 - SITE & SOB
Unit Code	MR501
Unit Title	Research Skills
Assessment Type	Assignment 3 - Individual
Assessment Title	Final Research Method Design Report
Purpose of the assessment (with ULO Mapping)	Students should be able to demonstrate their achievements in the following unit learning outcomes: - Articulate major research methodologies and paradigms in constructing research project. - Design appropriate research framework in problem formulation, literature review, design, and validation of hypothesis. - Assemble selected research tools and methodologies that satisfy the research objectives and the design goals
Weight	50 % of total assessment
Total Marks	50 Marks
Word limit	4500 words
Release Date	Week 2
Due Date	Week 12 (Wednesday 03 rd June 2026 at 5.00PM on Moodle)
Submission Guidelines including the use of Gen AI Tools	- Students are [NOT] permitted to use GenAI in this assessment. Please refer to the MIT Use of GenAI Policy - All work must be submitted on Moodle by the due date along with a completed Assignment Cover Page. - The assignment must be in MS Word format, 1.5 spacing, 11-pt Calibri (Body) font and 2.54 cm margins on all four sides of your page with appropriate section headings. - Reference sources must be cited in the text of the report and listed appropriately at the end in a reference list using the APA referencing style (for SOB) and IEEE (For SITE).
Extension	If an extension of time to submit work is required, a Special Consideration Application must be submitted directly on AMS. You must submit this application three working days prior to the due date of the assignment.



	Further information is available at: https://www.mit.edu.au/about-us/governance/institute-rules-policies-and-plans/policies-procedures-and-guidelines/assessment-policy
Academic Misconduct	Academic Misconduct is a serious offence. Depending on the seriousness of the case, penalties can vary from a written warning or zero marks to exclusion from the course or rescinding the degree. Students should make themselves familiar with the full policy and procedure available at: https://www.mit.edu.au/about-mit/institute-publications/policies-procedures-and-guidelines/AcademicIntegrityPolicyAndProcedure For further information, please refer to the Academic Integrity Section in your Unit Description.



Assessment 3: Final Research Method Design Report

Weighting: 50%

Purpose:

This assessment serves as a capstone task in the Research Skills subject. It is designed to evaluate your ability to apply the concepts, techniques, and tools discussed throughout the semester to design a comprehensive research plan. The task mimics the early stages of a Master's thesis proposal and is intended to prepare you for independent research in your discipline.

The Final Method Design Report must be directly aligned with the research topic selected by each student in MR601.

Report Structure & Guidelines:

Your Research Method Design Report must be clearly structured into the following sections. Each section contributes to your final grade. Submit the report (4500 words) on Moodle.

1. Title Page and Abstract (4 marks)

A concise, informative, and discipline-specific title

An abstract (200–250 words) that summarizes the research aim, rationale, methodology, and anticipated outcomes

2. Introduction and Research Problem Definition (8 marks)

Background of the study: Contextual information to introduce the topic

Statement of the research problem: What issue or gap in knowledge are you addressing?

Research objectives and aim: Clear, actionable, and relevant to your field

Justification of the topic: Why is this research important? Who will benefit?

3. Systematic Literature Review (8 marks)

Thematic structure (not just a list of articles): Categorize literature into themes

Analysis and synthesis: Compare and contrast findings across key studies

Identify knowledge gaps: What is missing or under-researched?

Use at least 10–12 peer-reviewed academic sources (with a strong preference for publications from the last 5 years)

4. Research Questions, Hypotheses and Objectives (4 marks)

Formulate clearly defined research questions

Hypotheses (if applicable): Based on your literature findings, develop logical and testable hypotheses

Develop 3-4 Research Objectives

5. Research Methodology and Design (20 marks)

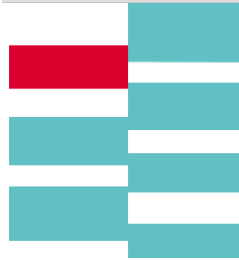
This is the most critical part of your report and must include:

- Research paradigm: Quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods – and justification

- Research design: Exploratory, descriptive, correlational, or experimental

- Data collection methods: Surveys, interviews, focus groups, content analysis, case studies, etc.

- Sampling technique and population: Describe the participants/respondents and how they will be selected (e.g., purposive sampling, stratified sampling, etc.)



- Instrumentation: Provide sample survey questions or interview guidelines in an appendix
- Data analysis plan: Explain what techniques/software/tools you will use (e.g., thematic coding, regression analysis, SPSS, NVivo)
- Feasibility and timelines: Provide a realistic timeline of tasks over a semester or year

6. Ethical Considerations and Data Security (2 marks)

Identify any ethical concerns (e.g., participant consent, privacy, use of data)
Describe how you will address ethical risks

7. Conclusion and Limitations (2 marks)

Summarize key points of your research design
Identify any foreseeable limitations and how you plan to mitigate them

8. References (APA 7th Edition or IEEE) (2 marks)

Include all in-text citations and references in correct APA 7th or IEEE style
Ensure accuracy, consistency, and academic integrity

9. Appendices

Literature review matrix
Survey/interview questions
Any charts, graphs, or additional tools/templates

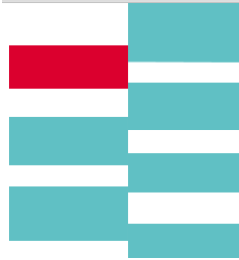
Report Structure & Marking Guide

Section	Marks	Description
1. Title Page & Abstract	4	Title must be concise and discipline specific. Abstract (200–250 words) summarizing aim, rationale, methodology, and expected outcomes.
2. Introduction & Research Problem	8	Background, problem statement, research aim/objectives, justification, and significance.
3. Systematic Literature Review	8	Thematic synthesis of 10–12 recent peer-reviewed sources, identifying gaps.
4. Research Questions, Hypotheses & Objectives	4	Clearly defined questions, 3–4 SMART objectives, and hypotheses (if applicable).
5. Research Methodology & Design	20	Paradigm, design type, data collection, sampling, instrumentation, analysis plan, feasibility, and timeline.
6. Ethical Considerations & Data Security	2	Address consent, privacy, and data handling.
7. Conclusion & Limitations	2	Summary of design and anticipated limitations.
8. References	2	APA 7th or IEEE style, accurate and consistent.



Marking Guide (Rubrics) for Assessment 3:

Criteria	HD (80-100%) Excellent	D (70-79%) Very Good	C (60-69%) Good	P (50-59%) Satisfactory	N (0-49%) Unsatisfactory
Title & Abstract (4marks)	Title is clear, specific, and professional. Abstract is comprehensive, accurately summarizing aim, rationale, methodology, and expected outcomes.	Title and abstract are appropriate and mostly accurate; minor details could be expanded.	Title and abstract are acceptable but slightly vague; some key components missing.	Title or abstract lacks clarity; misses 1-2 important components.	Title and abstract are unclear or missing; fails to provide purpose of the study.
Introduction & Research Problem (8 marks)	Strong background and context; clear and well-justified problem statement; research aim and objectives are precise and aligned.	Very good context and problem statement; objectives mostly aligned.	Acceptable background; research problem is somewhat justified; objectives present.	Some attempt at framing the problem; objectives unclear or misaligned.	Weak or missing background; unclear problem statement; aim and objectives not evident.
Literature Review (8 marks)	Thematic, analytical, and critical review; excellent use of recent and relevant sources; gap clearly identified.	Good thematic structure; mostly critical; uses relevant and recent sources; gap identified.	Mostly descriptive with some critical insight; some outdated or less relevant sources.	Literature review is general and lacks structure; limited sources; gap not clearly explained.	Poorly structured or missing review; minimal or irrelevant sources; no identified gap.
Research Questions & Hypotheses (4 marks)	Questions are clear, coherent, and researchable; hypotheses are well-formulated and strongly linked to literature.	Clear questions and logical hypotheses; minor alignment issues.	Questions are mostly relevant; hypotheses acceptable but need refinement.	Questions are vague or generic; hypotheses unclear or missing.	Questions are missing or unrelated; hypotheses absent.
Methodology & Research Design (20 marks)	Comprehensive design; well-justified methodology; excellent clarity on data collection, sampling, instruments, and analysis plan.	Methodology and design are sound with minor justification gaps.	Satisfactory description of design; some parts need more explanation or rationale.	Limited explanation; major components missing or unclear.	Inadequate or flawed methodology; lacks coherence and justification.
Ethics & Data	Ethical	Ethical concerns	General	Ethical	Ethics not



Security (2 marks)	considerations and data handling are thoroughly addressed; references to standards/codes; privacy, consent, and storage clearly discussed.	identified and reasonably discussed; minor detail missing.	ethical points covered; lacks specificity or depth.	concerns vaguely addressed; unclear mitigation strategies.	considered or poorly addressed; no standards or protections identified.
Conclusion & Limitations (2 marks)	Clear summary of proposal; insightful recognition of limitations and mitigation strategies.	Clear conclusion: limitations acknowledged.	General summary; limitations mentioned briefly.	Weak conclusion; limitations not clearly discussed.	Conclusion missing or unrelated; limitations not identified.
References – Style (APA 7 or IEEE) (2 marks)	Fully accurate referencing throughout; wide range of sources used.	Mostly correct referencing; minor inconsistencies.	Some referencing errors; limited variety of sources.	Frequent errors in referencing format.	Inconsistent or missing references; incorrect style.